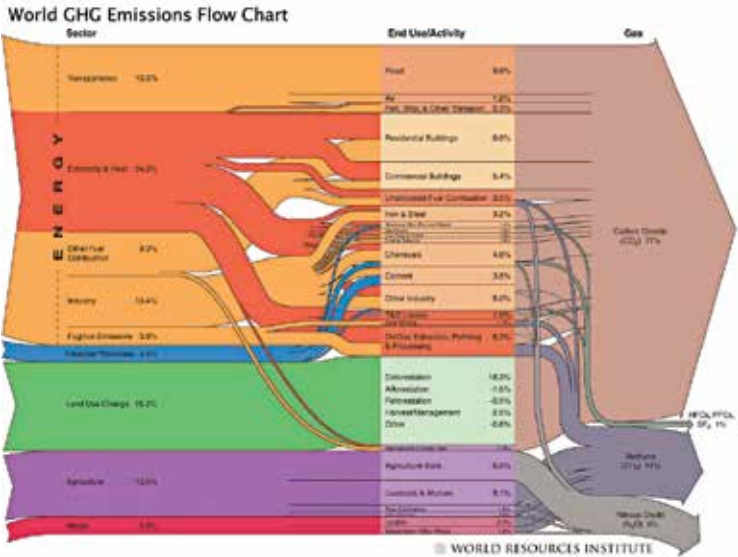




evant 100-year global warming potential” but who understands that gibberish. Let’s translate that into layman’s terms. Your carbon footprint is the amount of carbon dioxide (or carbon dioxide equivalent of greenhouse gases) you produce directly or indirectly (we’ll visit the direct and indirect part in just a minute).

Just for comparison, note that Methane absorbs ten times more sunlight than a carbon dioxide molecule. This means that the amount of heat absorbed by a molecule of methane is equivalent to ten molecules of carbon dioxide. Carbon dioxide is emitted by nearly all major human activity from manufacturing goods to making roads, producing and transporting food to providing services. Even a Google search produces carbon dioxide. In 2009, Google revealed on its official blog that every Google search produces an average of 0.2g of CO₂.

Now let’s come back to our topic of direct and indirect carbon emissions, also known as primary and secondary footprints. A primary footprint is a measure of the direct CO₂ emissions due to the burning of fossil fuels. An example of this is driving a car or hopping onto a plane. Not only this, it also includes your domestic energy usage such as through cooking etc. The secondary or indirect footprint is produced by every product used by you. This is emitted during manufacturing, transportation and eventual